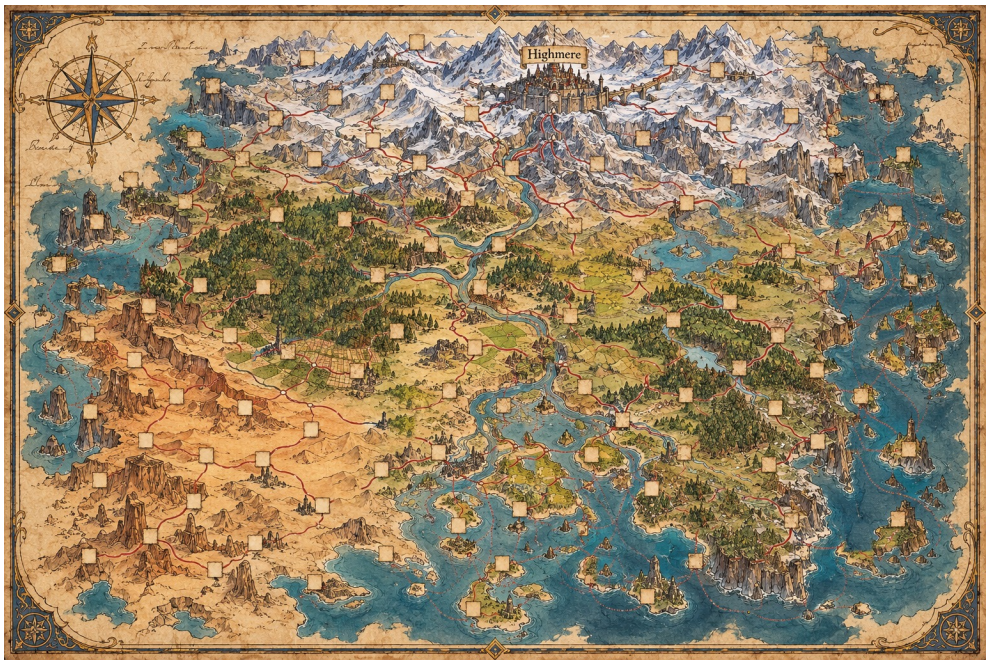
THIS YEAR'S MCC AWARD BOOK

100 Puzzles



The Great Map of Highmere. The pale slips mark the hundred places that have fallen silent.

To the young problem-solvers of Math Club & Competitions,

My name is Orla. I keep the Great Map of Highmere: mountains in brown ink, rivers in blue, roads in fine red lines. Travellers, healers and merchants all find their way by it.

But a hundred places on my map now lie under small square slips of paper, which I pasted there myself. On each slip I wrote the last news I had of that place, and on some I could write nothing at all. The places are still there, and people still live in them, but each has fallen silent: a gate that will not open, a lighthouse gone dark, a village cut off by the sea, a trouble nobody there can solve. So four of my apprentices have set out, with a very small dragon and a raven, to help one place at a time. Each time they send me a sketch, I lift that slip and draw in what is new.

They will need company. This winter, the club's award winners will receive the first half of the journey: fifty places, each with its story, its picture and its puzzle, and every answer explained at the back. Some puzzles are gentle; some will keep a strong high-school student busy for an evening. All of them need only careful thinking, a pencil, and the courage to try an idea that might not work.

The road starts at Coldhearth, a day out of Highmere. Bring a warm coat.

Orla
Master of the Great Map, Highmere

FOR PARENTS

A gift for the club's award winners







What it is. *100 Puzzles* is an illustrated book of original story puzzles in mathematics, logic and science, written for MCC. Each puzzle is a short story with its own picture, a clear list of what is allowed, and two or three questions that climb in difficulty. Hints and complete solutions, written for students, are at the back.

Who it is for. Students from about Grade 6 upwards, with puzzles that also stretch high-school students. Each puzzle is marked *Explorer*, *Investigator* or *Master*. Any science a puzzle needs is explained inside it, in plain words with an example, and many solutions end with a short science corner linking the puzzle to the real world.

One story. The hundred puzzles are one journey across a map: four apprentices, a small dragon and a raven bringing silent places back to life. Every puzzle can still be read and solved on its own.

Two volumes. Volume 1 (puzzles 1–50) is given to the club's first-semester award winners in December 2026. Volume 2 (puzzles 51–100) follows.

English or Vietnamese. Each winner chooses English or Vietnamese. Each edition is written to read naturally in its own language, and the two are checked line by line, so they have the same stories, pictures, map, rules and answers. Brothers, sisters and friends reading different editions can talk about the same puzzles.

Try it now. A free sample with the Prologue and three puzzles (1, 6 and 9), with hints and full solutions, is on the club website in both languages. Ordering details for an extra copy will also appear there.